

GET FIT WITH ME

03

WORKOUTS

FREE GUIDE

The Glute Starter Guide

Three glute workouts and the principles behind them.

Tap to open the interactive program →

Danielle Dawson

3 WORKOUTS · 1 WEEK · FREE



How to use this book

This book is the companion to your interactive app. The app is the fastest way to train: it logs every set, remembers your weights, runs your rest timer and charts your progress. This PDF gives you the same material in a format you can read, print and fill in.

Tap here to open your interactive program →

The interactive program tracks every set, runs your rest timer, charts your progress and includes every chapter with quizzes. On your phone, tap *Share → Add to Home Screen* so it opens like an app.

This PDF is interactive. Tap any entry in the table of contents to jump to it, use your PDF reader's bookmarks panel to navigate, and fill in the workbook pages at the back directly in Adobe Acrobat, Apple Books/Preview, or most PDF apps. Your entries save with the file.

This program is for educational purposes and is not medical advice. Consult your doctor before starting a new exercise or nutrition plan, especially if you are pregnant, injured or have a medical condition. Stop any exercise that causes pain.

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Contents

PART I

The Guide 4

01 Welcome to Your Glute Starter Guide 5

02 Glute Basics in 2 Minutes 6

03 The 4 Rules for Glute Growth 7

04 Technique Essentials 8

05 What's Next 9

PART II

The Program 10

Week 1 · Starter 11

PART III

Exercise Library 12

PART IV

Fillable Workbook 20

PART I

The Guide

5 chapters. Read Chapters 1–4 before you start, and use the rest as a reference.

CHAPTER 1

Welcome to Your Glute Starter Guide

This free guide gives you three of my favorite glute workouts plus the core principles I teach every client. Do all three this week with a rest day in between, log your weights and come back next week to beat them.

Your week

DAY	WORKOUT
Monday	Workout A · Glute Wake-Up
Wednesday	Workout B · Glute Builder Lite
Friday	Workout C · Lower Body Burn

CHAPTER 2

Glute Basics in 2 Minutes

Your glutes are three muscles:

- **Gluteus maximus:** the big one that creates size and shape. Trained by hip extension: hip thrusts, bridges, RDLs, lunges.
- **Gluteus medius & minimus:** on the side of your hip. Trained by abduction: banded walks, abduction machine, fire hydrants.

Training all three from different angles is how you build round, full glutes.

CHAPTER 3

The 4 Rules for Glute Growth

1. Progressive overload

Each week, add a rep or a little weight. If you do the same thing every week, your body has no reason to change.

2. Train close to failure

Stop each set when you could only do about **1–3 more good reps**. Easy sets don't build muscle.

3. Control every rep

Lower slowly for about 2 seconds, squeeze at the top. Momentum steals tension from your glutes.

4. Eat enough protein

Aim for **0.7–1.0 g of protein per pound of goal body weight** daily. Muscle is built from protein.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

When should a working set usually end?

A. When it starts to burn

B. When you could only do about 1–3 more good reps

C. After exactly 10 reps no matter what

Answer: B. Sets need to be close to failure to build muscle. Stop with about 1–3 good reps left.

CHAPTER 4

Technique Essentials

Hip thrusts & bridges: chin tucked, ribs down, drive through your heels and squeeze at the top. If you feel it in your lower back, you're arching. Tilt your pelvis under instead.

RDLs: push your hips back, keep the weights close to your legs and stop when your hamstrings are fully stretched. Your back stays flat.

Split squats & lunges: lean your torso slightly forward and push through your front heel for more glute focus.

See the **Exercise Library** tab for step-by-step instructions, cues and common mistakes for every move.

CHAPTER 5

What's Next

If you enjoyed this, the **Glute Specialist Program** is the full 8-week version: 32 progressive workouts, a complete exercise library, a 14-chapter training handbook, progress charts and a printable PDF book. It's everything I know about building glutes.

PART II

The Program

Every workout, week by week. Log your sets in the app or in the fillable workbook at the back of this book.

Week 1

STARTER PHASE

Do A, B and C this week with a rest day between each. Log your weights to beat them next week.

Workout A · Glute Wake-Up

Activation and foundational patterns.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Glute Bridge	3 × 12–15	2	60s
Banded Lateral Walk	3 × 12–15 /side	2	60s
Goblet Squat	3 × 10–12	2–3	90s
Romanian Deadlift	3 × 10–12	2–3	90s
Dumbbell Kickback	3 × 12–15 /side	2	60s

Workout B · Glute Builder Lite

A preview of the Glute Specialist Program.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Barbell Hip Thrust	3 × 10–12	2–3	90s
Bulgarian Split Squat	3 × 12–15 /side	2	60s
Cable Kickback	3 × 12–15 /side	2	60s
Hip Abduction Machine	3 × 12–15	2	60s
Frog Pumps	2 × 20	1	45s

Workout C · Lower Body Burn

Strength and single-leg work.

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	RIR	REST
Sumo Deadlift	3 × 10–12	2–3	90s
Step-Ups	3 × 12–15 /side	2	60s
Single-Leg Glute Bridge	3 × 12–15 /side	2	60s
Reverse Lunge	3 × 12–15 /side	2	60s
Fire Hydrants	2 × 20 /side	1	45s

PART III

Exercise Library

Setup, execution, cues, common mistakes and swaps for all 15 exercises in this program.

Banded Lateral Walk

Glutes · Glute med, glute min · Equipment: Mini band

SETUP

1. Place a mini band just above your knees (or around ankles for more challenge).
2. Get into a quarter squat.

EXECUTION

1. Step sideways, keeping tension on the band.
2. Keep your toes pointed forward and your hips level.
3. Complete all steps one way, then return.

CUES

- Stay low
- Never let the band go slack

COMMON MISTAKES

- Standing up tall
- Feet coming together

EASIER / HARDER

Lighter band / Band around ankles or heavier band

SWAPS

Hip Abduction Machine

Barbell Hip Thrust

Glutes · Glute max (primary), hamstrings, adductors · Equipment: Barbell, bench, bar pad

SETUP

1. Sit on the floor with the lower edge of your shoulder blades against a bench (bench height ~16 in / 40 cm is ideal).
2. Roll a padded barbell over your legs until it sits in the crease of your hips.
3. Feet flat, roughly hip-width, toes slightly out. At the top, your shins should be vertical.

EXECUTION

1. Brace your core and tuck your chin so your eyes look forward, not at the ceiling.
2. Drive through your heels and mid-foot to lift your hips until your torso is parallel to the floor.
3. Posteriorly tilt your pelvis at the top (think 'ribs down, tailbone under') and squeeze for 1 second.
4. Lower under control until your hips are just above the floor, then repeat without resting at the bottom.

CUES

- Ribs down, chin tucked
- Push the floor away through your heels
- Pivot around the bench — your upper back stays put

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the lower back at the top instead of squeezing the glutes
- Feet too close (more quads) or too far (more hamstrings)
- Looking at the ceiling, which pulls you into extension
- Rushing the top — no lockout, no squeeze

EASIER / HARDER

Glute Bridge or Machine Hip Thrust / Pause 3 sec at the top, or 1.5-rep thrusts

SWAPS

Smith Machine Hip Thrust, Machine Hip Thrust, Single-Leg Hip Thrust

Bulgarian Split Squat

Glutes · Glute max, quads, adductors · Equipment: Bench, dumbbells

SETUP

1. Stand about two feet in front of a bench and place the top of your back foot on it.
2. Hold dumbbells at your sides. Your front foot should be far enough forward that your front heel stays down at the bottom.

EXECUTION

1. Lean your torso forward slightly (about 20–30°) to bias the glutes.
2. Lower straight down until your back knee is just above the floor.
3. Drive through your whole front foot, emphasizing the heel, to return to the top.
4. Complete all reps on one side before switching.

CUES

- Down, not forward
- Front foot does the work — back foot is just for balance
- Lean in for glutes, stay upright for quads

COMMON MISTAKES

- Front foot too close, causing the heel to lift
- Pushing off the back foot
- Collapsing the front knee inward
- Going too heavy too soon and losing balance

EASIER / HARDER

Reverse Lunge or Split Squat with back foot on floor / Deficit front foot, 3-sec lowering, or 1.5 reps

SWAPS

Reverse Lunge, Step-Ups, Smith Machine Split Squat

Cable Kickback

Glutes · Glute max (upper fibers), glute med · Equipment: Cable machine, ankle strap

SETUP

1. Attach an ankle strap at the lowest pulley setting and secure it to your working ankle.
2. Face the machine, hold the frame, and hinge forward slightly with a soft standing knee.

EXECUTION

1. Keeping your torso still, kick the working leg back and slightly out (about 30° from center).
2. Stop when your glute is fully squeezed — before your lower back arches.
3. Hold for 1 second, then return slowly until the weight stack almost touches.

CUES

- Back and slightly out
- Hips square to the machine
- Squeeze, don't swing

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the back to get more range
- Using momentum
- Rotating the hips open
- Too much weight — this is a feel exercise

EASIER / HARDER

Banded Kickback or Dumbbell Kickback / 2-sec pause at peak contraction

SWAPS

Glute Kickback Machine, Dumbbell Kickback

Dumbbell Kickback

Glutes · Glute max · Equipment: Dumbbell, mat

SETUP

1. Start on all fours and place a light dumbbell in the crease behind one knee.

EXECUTION

1. Keeping your knee bent, drive your heel toward the ceiling.
2. Stop before your lower back arches.
3. Lower with control.

CUES

- Heel to the ceiling
- Back flat like a table

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the back
- Dropping the dumbbell — start light

EASIER / HARDER

Bodyweight donkey kick / Cable Kickback

SWAPS

Cable Kickback

Fire Hydrants

Glutes · Glute med, glute min · Equipment: Mat, mini band optional

SETUP

1. Start on all fours with your hands under your shoulders and knees under your hips.

EXECUTION

1. Keeping your knee bent, lift it out to the side.
2. Keep your hips square to the floor.
3. Lower slowly.

CUES

- Hips stay square
- Slow lower

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaning to the side
- Rushing

EASIER / HARDER

Smaller range / Add a mini band

SWAPS

Side-Lying Hip Raise

Frog Pumps

Glutes · Glute max · Equipment: Bodyweight or a dumbbell

SETUP

1. Lie on your back, put the soles of your feet together and let your knees fall out.
2. Bring your heels close to your glutes.

EXECUTION

1. Drive your hips up while squeezing your glutes hard.
2. Lower and repeat quickly with control — this is a high-rep pump finisher.

CUES

- Squeeze, don't arch
- Knees stay open

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pushing through the lower back
- Range too short

EASIER / HARDER

Glute Bridge / Hold a dumbbell on your hips

SWAPS

Glute Bridge, Banded Bridge

Glute Bridge

Glutes · Glute max, hamstrings · Equipment: Mat, band or dumbbell optional

SETUP

1. Lie on your back with knees bent and heels about 6 inches from your glutes.

EXECUTION

1. Brace your core and drive through your heels to lift your hips.
2. Squeeze your glutes at the top for 2 seconds.
3. Lower with control.

CUES

- Ribs down
- Heels heavy

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the lower back
- Feet too far away

EASIER / HARDER

Shorter range / Banded or single-leg bridge

SWAPS

Hip Thrust, Frog Pumps

Goblet Squat

Legs · Quads, glutes, core · Equipment: Dumbbell or kettlebell

SETUP

1. Hold a dumbbell vertically against your chest, elbows pointing down.
2. Feet slightly wider than hips, toes slightly out.

EXECUTION

1. Sit down between your hips, keeping your chest up.
2. Let your elbows track inside your knees at the bottom.
3. Drive up through your whole foot.

CUES

- Elbows inside knees
- Chest tall

COMMON MISTAKES

- Heels lifting
- Rounding forward

EASIER / HARDER

Box Squat to a bench / Pause at the bottom or heavier weight

SWAPS

Leg Press, Smith Machine Squat

Hip Abduction Machine

Glutes · Glute med, glute min, upper glute max · Equipment: Hip abduction machine

SETUP

1. Set the start position so your legs begin together with tension on the pads.
2. For more glute focus, lean your torso forward over your thighs and hold the sides of the seat.

EXECUTION

1. Push your knees out against the pads as far as you can control.
2. Pause briefly, then return slowly — don't let the weights slam.
3. On the final set, finish with partial reps at the outer range until failure.

CUES

- Lead with your knees
- Slow on the way in
- Lean forward for upper glutes

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the stack bang between reps
- Using momentum from the torso
- Cutting the range short on every rep

EASIER / HARDER

Lighter weight with full range / Lean-forward version + 10 partials at the end

SWAPS

Banded Seated Abduction, Cable Hip Abduction, Side-Lying Hip Raise

Reverse Lunge

Legs · Glutes, quads · Equipment: Dumbbells optional

SETUP

1. Stand tall with feet hip-width apart.

EXECUTION

1. Step one foot back and lower until both knees are bent about 90°.
2. Push through your front heel to return to standing.

CUES

- Step back long
- Front heel drives

COMMON MISTAKES

- Front knee caving
- Short step

EASIER / HARDER

Hold a support / Deficit reverse lunge

SWAPS

Bulgarian Split Squat

Romanian Deadlift

Glutes · Hamstrings, glute max, spinal erectors · Equipment: Barbell or dumbbells

SETUP

1. Stand tall holding the bar or dumbbells in front of your thighs, feet hip-width.
2. Unlock your knees slightly — they stay at this bend for the whole set.
3. Pull your shoulders back and down and brace your core.

EXECUTION

1. Push your hips straight back like you're closing a car door with your glutes.
2. Let the weight slide down the front of your thighs, staying close to your legs.
3. Lower until you feel a strong hamstring stretch — usually mid-shin. Your back stays neutral.
4. Drive your hips forward to stand, squeezing your glutes at the top without leaning back.

CUES

- Hips back, not down
- Weight stays glued to your legs
- Proud chest, long spine

COMMON MISTAKES

- Squatting the weight down (bending the knees more)
- Rounding the lower back to reach the floor
- Letting the weight drift away from your body
- Hyperextending at the top

EASIER / HARDER

Dumbbell RDL with a shorter range, or Cable Pull-Through / Single-Leg RDL, Deficit RDL, 3-sec lowering

SWAPS

Dumbbell RDL, Good Morning, 45° Back Extension

Single-Leg Glute Bridge

Glutes · Glute max, glute med · Equipment: Mat

SETUP

1. Lie on your back with one foot planted and the other leg straight or bent up.

EXECUTION

1. Drive through the planted heel to lift your hips.
2. Keep your hips level and squeeze at the top.
3. Lower with control.

CUES

- Level hips
- Squeeze at the top

COMMON MISTAKES

- Hips rotating
- Pushing through the toes

EASIER / HARDER

Two-leg bridge / Elevate the foot on a bench

SWAPS

Single-Leg Hip Thrust

Step-Ups

Legs · Glutes, quads · Equipment: Box or bench, dumbbells

SETUP

1. Use a box or bench about knee height.
2. Place your whole working foot on the box.

EXECUTION

1. Lean slightly forward and drive through your top heel to stand up on the box.
2. Don't push off with your bottom foot — keep it light.
3. Lower slowly back down with the same leg.

CUES

- Top leg does all the work
- Slow on the way down

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pushing off the bottom toes
- Box too low
- Knee caving in

EASIER / HARDER

Lower box, no weight / Higher box or heavier dumbbells

SWAPS

Bulgarian Split Squat, Reverse Lunge

Sumo Deadlift

Glutes · Glutes, adductors, quads, hamstrings · Equipment: Barbell, kettlebell or dumbbell

SETUP

1. Take a wide stance with toes turned out 30–45°.
2. Grip the bar (or one heavy dumbbell) inside your knees.
3. Drop your hips, lift your chest and pull the slack out of the bar.

EXECUTION

1. Push the floor apart with your feet as you stand up.
2. Keep the bar close to your body.
3. Finish by squeezing your glutes — don't lean back.
4. Hinge back down under control.

CUES

- Spread the floor
- Chest up, hips through
- Knees out over toes

COMMON MISTAKES

- Hips shooting up first
- Knees caving
- Rounding the back

EASIER / HARDER

Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift / Barbell Sumo Deadlift with a pause below the knee

SWAPS

Trap-Bar Deadlift, Kettlebell Sumo Deadlift

Workout A · Glute Wake-Up

WEEK 1 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Starter phase · Activation and foundational patterns.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Glute Bridge 3 × 12–15 · RIR 2 · 60s				☐
Banded Lateral Walk 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 60s				☐
Goblet Squat 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 90s				☐
Romanian Deadlift 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 90s				☐
Dumbbell Kickback 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 60s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Workout B · Glute Builder Lite

WEEK 1 · LOG

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Starter phase · A preview of the Glute Specialist Program.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Barbell Hip Thrust 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 90s				☐
Bulgarian Split Squat 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 60s				☐
Cable Kickback 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 60s				☐
Hip Abduction Machine 3 × 12–15 · RIR 2 · 60s				☐
Frog Pumps 2 × 20 · RIR 1 · 45s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets

New PR?

Workout C · Lower Body Burn

Date	Bodyweight	Energy (1–10)	Sleep (hrs)

Starter phase · Strength and single-leg work.

EXERCISE	SET 1 LB × REPS	SET 2 LB × REPS	SET 3 LB × REPS	✓
Sumo Deadlift 3 × 10–12 · RIR 2–3 · 90s				☐
Step-Ups 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 60s				☐
Single-Leg Glute Bridge 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 60s				☐
Reverse Lunge 3 × 12–15 /side · RIR 2 · 60s				☐
Fire Hydrants 2 × 20 /side · RIR 1 · 45s				☐

WARM-UP NOTES

HOW DID IT FEEL? WHAT WILL YOU CHANGE NEXT TIME?

Workout complete ☐

Total sets	New PR?